



VAMPIRE BAT
Mexico to South America



BRAZIL NUT TREE
South America



KAPOK TREE
Mexico; Central and South America; West Africa



MALAYAN FLYING FOX
Southeast Asia



BLACK SPIDER MONKEY
South America



GUEREZA
West and Central Africa



KINKAJOU
Mexico to South America



MALACHITE
North to South America



TAWNY RAJAH
South Asia



PILEATED GIBBON
Southeast Asia



ANT PLANT
Southeast Asia; Australia



POSTMAN BUTTERFLY
Central and South America



SOUTH AMERICAN COATI
South America



JUNGLE NYMPH
Southeast Asia



BROMELIAD PLANT
Mexico to South America



COCOA TREE
Central and South America



GIANT ANTEATER
Central and South America



JAGUAR
Central and South America



ANACONDA
South America and Trinidad



SCARLET IBIS
South America; Caribbean

Rainforest

Tropical rainforests grow in regions that are always warm and wet, so trees and other plants can grow, flower, and produce seeds and fruit all year round. The trees provide homes and food for an amazing variety of animals, with more different species than anywhere else on Earth.

WHERE IN THE WORLD?

Tropical rainforests grow near the equator. The climate here is hot and wet all year round, and has no cold winters or dry summers. The biggest areas of rainforest are in Central and South America, Central Africa, Southeast Asia, and New Guinea. There are smaller patches in Madagascar, India, and northern Australia.



THE AMAZON TROPICAL RAINFOREST IS THE LARGEST IN THE WORLD



DEADLY LIFE IN THE RAINFOREST

The forests provide homes for many dangerous animals and plants. This list includes some of the most deadly.

POISON-DART FROG

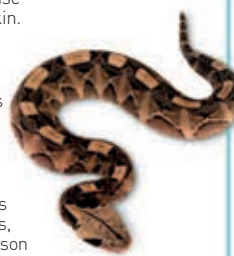
These tiny, but vividly coloured frogs from tropical America release toxins through their skin.



STRAWBERRY POISON-DART FROG

GABOON VIPER

This heavy-bodied venomous snake lurks in ambush on the African forest floor.



GABOON VIPER

CURARE

Extracted from various South American plants, curare was used to poison the tips of blow darts for hunting.

BRAZILIAN WANDERING SPIDER

This big, long-legged hunter is the world's most deadly spider.

BULLET ANT

Native to Central and South America, this giant ant has such a painful sting that people say it feels like being hit by a bullet from a gun.

TYPES OF RAINFORESTS

The nature of rainforests depends on where they grow. The tallest trees grow in the warm lowlands, while smaller trees and different types of plants grow higher up in the mountains where the climate is cooler.

LOWLAND RAINFOREST

The warm, wet lowland rainforest has the most plant and animal life, and the richest variety of species.



CLOUD FOREST

Mountain forests are often hidden in the clouds. The trees are always wet and covered with mosses.



FLOODED RAINFOREST

Every year, forests near rivers become flooded. The trees are surrounded by water inhabited by fish and turtles.



LOSING THE RAINFORESTS

At least half the world's rainforests have been cut down for timber or to make way for farms. An area the size of a football pitch is cut down every second. If people carry on doing this, the forests will disappear.



AGRICULTURE

Trees are felled so crops can be grown on the land. Some crops are used to make fuel for our cars.



CATTLE RANCHES

Meat for burgers is produced on ranches – fields of grass created on land that was once rainforest.



LOGGING

Many rainforest trees are cut down for valuable timber called hardwood, which is sold worldwide.



MINING

Minerals such as copper are mined from huge pits dug in the forest. These can cause river pollution.